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ASSESSMENT AND INTERNAL VERIFICATION FRONT SHEET (Individual Criteria)

(Note: This version is to be used for an assignment brief issued to students via Classter)

Course Title	**BA (Hons) in Interactive Digital Media**		**Lecturer**	**Redd Caruana**	
Unit Number & Title	CAIDM-506-2207 Prototyping & Testing Techniques				
Assignment Title	Iterative Validation				
Date Set	3 March 2026	Deadline Date	29 May 2026		
Student Name		ID Number		Class / Group	

Assessment Criteria	Maximum Mark
AA1 Develop well-formulated plans for usability testing and prototyping for a digital application concept.	10
AA2 Employ a combination of unit and integration testing to expose initial issues in software prototypes.	10
AA5 Integrate iterative design solutions based on peer and user feedback.	10
EC1 Create prototypes at different levels whilst demonstrating sound Information Architecture practices.	10
EC3 Assess the user experience of a digital application in relation to initial design objectives.	10
Total Mark	50

Notes to Students:

- This assignment brief has been approved and released by the Internal Verifier through Classter.
- Assessment marks and feedback by the lecturer will be available online via Classter (http://mcast.classter.com) following release by the Internal Verifier
- Students submitting their assignment on Moodle/Turnitin will be requested to confirm online the following statements:

Student's declaration prior to handing-in of assignment

- I certify that the work submitted for this assignment is my own and that I have read and understood the respective Plagiarism Policy

Student's declaration on assessment special arrangements

- I certify that adequate support was given to me during the assignment through the Institute and/or the Inclusive Education Unit.

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Purpose and Aims

The widespread accessibility to various digital technologies has contributed to a vast number of apps and games, currently available at our fingertips through a variety of platforms. What tends to stand out in popular mobile apps, and frequently played games, is a seemingly deep understanding of the end users / players they target. Successful digital applications that achieve widespread use result from a rigorous prototyping and testing process which can be time-consuming and ongoing. In fact, a company's investment in research, testing and analysis is likely to spell out a greater success rate in their products and ultimately a deeper understanding of their audiences.

Scenario

Prototyping stands as an integral part of all development projects. It allows teams to visualize and test ideas before their full-scale implementation through tangible or interactive representations of the same software. This process helps identify design flaws, challenges in user experience, and functional gaps, and reduces costly mistakes in later stages.

This semester is about working smarter, not bigger. You will apply more structured user and functionality testing, using agile frameworks to guide your process. Through short, focused development cycles, you will test, reflect, and iterate, allowing feedback to shape the evolution of your product.

In short: you will be improving what you already built, not adding new features to it.

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Part 4: Sprint Planning and Testing Strategy

Before making changes, you must show that you understand where your project is heading. This task keeps your work focused and helps you plan realistic, testable improvements.

A. Confirm Project Direction

Define your intent for this semester, by stating one of the following:

- **Continuation: You are refining your existing MVP**

  You must briefly explain (approximately 1 page):

  - What your MVP currently does (short summary of its current state)
  - What is working well
  - What is not working well (usability, technical, clarity issues)
  - Why it is worth continuing

- **Pivot: You are adjusting part of your original concept**

  Include a short explanation (maximum 2 pages):

  - What is changing and why
  - What feedback or constraints led to this
  - What remains from the original idea
  - How this improves feasibility within the semester timeframe

- **Restart (subject to approval): You are proposing a new project**

  A short proposal (approximately 1 page) needs to be submitted explaining:

  - Why the original project cannot continue
  - What you learned from Semester 1
  - A reduced-scope MVP achievable within 2 – 3 weeks
  - A realistic timeline for the remainder of the semester

Your explanation must be supported by evidence where possible (for example: screenshots, user feedback quotes, bug logs, testing notes, analytics, or observations from Semester 1).

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B. Iteration Plan

Create a simple plan for the semester that includes:

- Two improvement goals for your project that improve usability, clarity, or stability.

  Examples:

  - *Make onboarding clearer*
  - *Reduce confusion in controls*
  - *Make UI readable*
  - *Reduce bugs in core loop*

- What you will test for each goal (2 short tests each)

  Examples:

  - *Can 3 new users complete the tutorial without asking questions?*
  - *Do users understand the core mechanic within the first 2 minutes?*

- How you'll know it worked (success criteria in plain language)

  Examples:

  - *At least 4 out of 5 users uploaded a task to the website without guidance*
  - *No breaking bugs occur after a level is repeated 10 consecutive times.*

- Your sprint rhythm (3 sprints over approximately 10 weeks)

  Examples:

  - *Weeks 1 – 3: Feature 1 (build → test → refine)*
  - *Weeks 4 – 6: Feature 2 (build → test → refine)*
  - *Weeks 7 – 9: Integration (build → test → refine → polish)*

Where possible, justify your Improvement Goals using evidence (for example: recurring feedback comments, observed confusion during playtests, technical instability, or usability issues identified in Semester 1).

Submission: Project Direction and Iteration Plan as PDF

Deadline: 13th March 2026

Grading Criteria: AA1

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Part 5: Studio Iterations

This part focuses on practical, hands-on iteration. You will run three structured sprints to improve your project through small builds, focused testing, and evidence-based refinement. The goal is to make clear, visible improvement.

A. Run Your Sprints

You must complete the three sprints outlined in your first task.

Each sprint must follow the same simple structure:

1. Build

- Work on the goal defined in Task 1
- **Keep the scope small and realistic**

2. Test

You must show evidence of:

i. Technical Testing (AA2)

- Basic functional checks appropriate to your project
- Example: bug checklist, manual test cases, reproduction steps, simple unit/integration tests

ii. User Testing

- At least one playtest or usability test per sprint
- Peer testing is acceptable
- Collect short notes, quotes, or observations

iii. Improve (AA5)

- Identify what worked and what didn't
- Make changes based on feedback and test results

During your sprints, you are expected to demonstrate structured and responsible problem-solving aligned with your iteration plan. You must clearly show that the improvements you proposed were intentionally developed, tested with evidence, and refined based on feedback and technical constraints.

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B. Sprint Portfolio (EC1)

Submit one **Sprint Portfolio** showing your progress for all three sprints.

Each sprint must include:

- Sprint goal
- "Before" evidence (screenshots / short clips)
- Testing evidence (technical + user)
- What you changed and why
- "After" evidence
- Evidence of how you tracked the sprint (project board screenshot or structured task list)

Acceptable evidence formats:

- screenshots with captions
- short video clips (30 – 90 seconds)
- simple bug lists
- photos of playtest notes
- project board screenshots (Planner, Trello, etc.)
- dated changelogs

Keep documentation clear and concise. Quality of thinking matters more than quantity of pages.

Submission: Sprint Portfolio in a ZIP file

Deadline: 15th May 2026

Grading Criteria: *AA2, AA5, EC1*

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Part 6: Final Showcase and Reflection

This task ensures that you can evaluate what you made and why it matters. You will reflect on the impact of your iterations and assess the user experience against your original objectives.

A. Studio Showcase

A 10-minute demo where you show:

- **The Evolution**

  Show a clear comparison (visual if possible) between your MVP and your current version. What are the most noticeable differences?

- **Two Sprint Stories**

  Walk the audience through two key moments from your sprints: what problem you faced, what you tried, and what happened as a result.

- **The Turning Point**

  Identify the single most impactful improvement. Why did it matter for the user experience?

- **A Smart Compromise**

  Describe one limitation you accepted (time, technical skill, scope) and explain how you adapted to it.

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B. Final Reflection

Write a critical summary (maximum 500 words) reflecting on the sprints how they impacted your work. Your points should include:

1. Your original objective (what you were trying to achieve)
2. What testing revealed overall (key feedback themes, patterns, surprises)
3. The most impactful improvement (and why it improved the experience)
4. What still isn't working (limitations or unresolved issues)
5. If you had 2 more weeks, what would you refine next?

You must clearly reference how user feedback influenced at least some of your final decisions. You may include visuals (screenshots or comparison images) if helpful, but the focus should be on insight.

Submission: Studio Showcase presentation / Reflection as PDF

Deadline: 29th May 2026

Grading Criteria: *EC3*

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Minimum Evidence List

1	Project Direction and Iteration Plan as PDF	☐
2	Sprint Portfolio as ZIP file	☐
3	Studio Showcase Presentation	☐
4	Final Reflection as PDF	☐

Print this page and hand in with your assignment on final hand in date.